MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 1, Episode 4

"In Between"

Episode 1x04. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 1x04. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Tuesday, July 26, 2005, 5:21 AM through Wednesday, July 27, 2005, 12:20 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 40 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-1x03

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on July 1, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Tuesday, July 26, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	25
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (10.5 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	27
Jada Spencer (new)	Patient: Wilms tumor	Nov 14, 1997	7
Tamara Spencer (new)	Jada's mother	Feb 20, 1977	28
Dr. Isaiah Crump	Chief of Pediatric Surgery	Mar 11, 1944	61
Inez Boatwright (new)	Patient: takotsubo cardiomyopathy	Apr 2, 1942	63
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Kiara Lattimore (new)	Patient: concealed pregnancy	Sep 1, 1988	16
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Dr. Lawrence Donohue	Pediatric oncologist, Atlanta (V.O.)	Mar 7, 1962	43
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband	Apr 3, 1975	30
Derrick Spencer (new)	Jada's father	Sep 5, 1974	30
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	46
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Denise Lattimore (new)	Kiara's mother	Jan 7, 1966	39
Dr. Bryce Kennerly (new)	Surgical Intern (another team)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Nurse Yvette Banks	Lead Scrub Nurse	Dec 1, 1963	41
Lynette Boatwright-Reyes (new)	Inez's daughter; RN	Aug 8, 1967	37

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	(voicemail only; unseen)	Mar 3, 1971	34

Also appearing: a CNN anchor (on TV), interns from other teams, a scrub team, and Dr. Thaddeus Boykin (mentioned). Clayton Hartwell is heard on voicemail only; his face is not seen.

Black don't crack (C-018): every regular reads several years younger than their age on screen. The ages above are exact and binding.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. OLD MAIN - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 5:21 AM

The locker room, before dawn. Raven and Harmony come in, yawning, coffee in hand, and stop dead.

Every locker, every mirror, every inch of the wall is covered in photocopies. The same image, over and over: a glossy magazine spread from 2002. ESTHER, twenty-two years old, in an elegant ivory lace slip and nothing else, against a gold backdrop. The tagline: "LUXE NOIR INTIMATES. CONFIDENCE IS THE FIRST LAYER." Someone has scrawled across one copy in Sharpie: "DR. PANTENE WILL SEE YOU NOW."

RAVEN
(horrified)
Oh, no.

HARMONY
Oh, no, no, no.

Raven starts ripping them down. Harmony joins her. There are dozens.

MARC (V.O.)
In medicine, there's a name for the space between what you were and what you're becoming.

MARC (V.O.)
Interns call it no man's land. You're not a student anymore. You're not quite a doctor. And everybody can see you standing in the middle.

The door opens. Esther walks in, bag over her shoulder, and sees it: the walls, the mirrors, her own twenty-two-year-old face looking back at her a hundred times.

She stops. Raven freezes with a fistful of torn paper.

RAVEN
Esther, we're getting them down, I swear, we got here and they were...

Esther doesn't say anything. She walks to her locker. Peels off the copy taped to it. Folds it neatly in half. Puts it in her bag.

2 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 5:40 AM

Marc and Amond are at the Board. Arianna comes in last, chewing gum. On the table by the coffee maker sits a stack of leftover photocopies. Marc picks one up. His face goes cold.

MARC
Who did this?

AMOND
(glancing at it, then away, embarrassed)
They're everywhere. The elevators. The cafeteria line. Someone put one on the Board this morning. I took it down.

Marc turns. Arianna has stopped chewing.

MARC
Arianna.

ARIANNA
Why are you looking at me?

MARC
Because you've called her "Pantene" thirty times in four weeks.

ARIANNA
Calling her Pantene and wallpapering the hospital are different hobbies.

MARC
Did you do it?

A beat. Arianna holds his gaze. Then looks away.

ARIANNA
(flat)
She was in a magazine. It's public. I found it in a box of old magazines at the laundromat. I made a few copies. Somebody else made a few hundred.

AMOND
(disgusted)
"A few."

MARC
(very quiet, very dangerous)
You know what she's been through? You have no idea what she's been through.

ARIANNA
And you do? You've known her a month.

Silence. Marc's jaw works. For a second the sweetest man in the room looks like he might put his fist through the Board. The certified crash-out is close to the surface.

Elxa walks in and reads the room in half a second.

ELXA
Whatever this is, it's over. Now. (beat) Cummings. My service. All day. You're doing every rectal exam in this building.

ARIANNA
I'm on Boykin's...

ELXA
Boykin traded you to me for a pack of cigarettes and his dignity. Go.

3 INT. OLD MAIN - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - CONTINUOUS
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 5:52 AM

The room has filled with interns from other teams, all of them getting changed, all of them pretending not to stare at the walls Raven and Harmony are still clearing. Esther stands at her locker, very calm.

Two male INTERNS by the sinks are snickering over a copy. One says, loud enough:

MALE INTERN
Confidence is the first layer.

Esther turns around. She looks at the whole room. Then, without hurrying, she unties her scrub pants and lets them drop. She pulls her scrub top over her head. She stands there in a plain cotton bra and underwear, arms at her

sides, completely composed.

Dead silence.

ESTHER
(calm, carrying)
This is a body. I've had it for twenty-five years. When I was twenty-two, a company paid me four thousand dollars to stand in front of a camera in it, and that money bought my baby sister's braces and my first year of medical school textbooks.

She looks at the snickering interns. They stop snickering.

ESTHER
Look all you want. Take a good look. Get it out of your system. Because in about ten minutes, this body is going to be standing in an operating room holding a retractor in someone's brain, and I'd like you all to be finished looking at it by then.

She takes fresh scrubs out of her locker. Puts them on. Ties the pants. Smooths her hair. Picks up her stethoscope.

ESTHER
(to Raven and Harmony, warmly)
Thank you for taking them down.

She walks out. Raven and Harmony look at each other.

HARMONY
(whispering)
I want to be her when I grow up.

RAVEN
(whispering)
We're the same age.

4 INT. PELL PAVILION - CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 5:58 AM

Esther walks fast down the corridor, chin up. She rounds the corner into an empty stretch of hallway... and only then does she put a hand flat on the wall and close her eyes, breathing hard, shaking.

Marc rounds the same corner behind her and stops.

MARC
Esther.

ESTHER
(not opening her eyes)
Don't. Please don't be nice to me right now. If you're nice to me, I'll cry, and if I cry, they win.

Marc stands there. Doesn't touch her. Just stands beside her against the wall, blocking her from the hallway with his body.

MARC
(quiet)
Okay. I'll be mean. (beat) Your handwriting on the Board is terrible.

A wet, startled laugh comes out of her.

ESTHER
(eyes still closed)
It's not.

MARC
It's illegible. Your sevens look like ones. Somebody's going to get the wrong dose of something.

ESTHER
(laughing, wiping her eyes)
Stop.

MARC
I'm being mean. You asked.

She opens her eyes and looks at him. Steady now.

ESTHER
Thank you.

SMASH TO:

MAIN TITLE: MERCY'S ANATOMY

ACT ONE

5 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - PEDS BAY - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 6:34 AM

JADA SPENCER (7), with beaded braids and a pink cast on her left arm, sits on the gurney eating a graham cracker, kicking her feet. Her mother, TAMARA SPENCER (28), a nurse's aide in purple scrubs from another hospital, stands beside her, arms crossed and worried. Dr. Isaiah Crump (61), bow tie and all, holds an ultrasound probe to Jada's belly. Marc watches the screen.

CRUMP
She fell off the monkey bars at P.S. 111 on Saturday. Broke her wrist. Urgent care did the cast and noticed her belly looked a little full on one side. Sent her here for an ultrasound. (to Marc) What do you see, Dr. Bullock?

On the screen: a large, round, solid mass where Jada's right kidney should be.

MARC
(carefully)
A solid mass. Right kidney. Large. It's displacing everything around it.

CRUMP
Age seven. Painless abdominal mass. Found by accident.

MARC
(very quietly)
Wilms tumor.

Tamara hears it.

TAMARA
A tumor? That's cancer? My baby has cancer?

CRUMP
(turning off the probe, gentle)
Mrs. Spencer. It's very likely a kind of kidney tumor called a Wilms tumor. I know the word "cancer" is terrifying. But I want you to hear this part, because it's the most important part. This is one of the most curable cancers in childhood. Most children with this tumor are cured. Most.

TAMARA
(sitting down hard)
Most.

JADA
(through graham cracker)
Mommy, why are you crying?

TAMARA
(pulling herself together)
I'm not crying, baby. The doctor's light is in my eyes.

JADA
(to Crump)
Turn off your light.

CRUMP
(smiling sadly)
Yes, ma'am.

6 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDS BAY - CONTINUOUS
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 6:52 AM

Tamara on her flip phone in the corner of the bay, low and intense. Marc is starting an IV on Jada, who's watching cartoons on the bay TV and ignoring the needle.

TAMARA
(into the phone)
...Derrick, I'm telling you what they told me. A kidney tumor. They want to do a CT today and probably surgery this week. (beat) No. (beat) No, I'm not putting her on a plane to Atlanta, are you crazy? (beat) Because her doctors are HERE. Because SHE'S here.

She listens. Her face hardens.

TAMARA
Don't you dare call my baby's doctors. Derrick. Derrick!

She snaps the phone shut. Turns to Marc, who is very carefully not listening.

TAMARA
Her father lives in Atlanta. He sees her at Christmas and two weeks in summer. He wants her transferred to "the best children's hospital in the South."

MARC
Which one?

TAMARA
The Donohue Children's Hospital. He says it's world-famous. He says he's calling them right now.

Marc's hand pauses on the IV tape for a fraction of a second. Then he finishes smoothing it down.

MARC
(very evenly)
That's a very good hospital.

TAMARA
You know it?

MARC
I've... heard of it.

7 INT. PELL PAVILION - CT STEP-DOWN - ROOM 5 - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 7:10 AM

MRS. INEZ BOATWRIGHT (63), in a church usher's white dress she was clearly wearing when she came in, lies on a stretcher on oxygen, a cardiac monitor beeping. Her EKG strip shows ST-segment elevation. Amond studies it like scripture. Robert reads the cath lab report.

AMOND
Classic anterior ST elevation. Chest pain since four a.m., troponin's up. It's an anterior MI. She needs the cath lab.

ROBERT
She's already been to the cath lab. They called me because of what they found. (handing him the report) Read it.

Amond reads. Frowns. Reads again.

AMOND
Her coronary arteries are clean. No blockage. But her left ventricle... the apex isn't contracting. It's ballooned out. Like a...

ROBERT
Like a what?

AMOND
(beat)
Like a Japanese octopus trap. Takotsubo. Stress cardiomyopathy. (beat) That's rare.

ROBERT
It's rarely diagnosed. Not the same thing. (to Mrs. Boatwright) Mrs. Boatwright, when did your husband pass?

Amond looks up, startled. How does he know?

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
(eyes filling)
Sunday. Sunday morning. Forty-one years. He was getting dressed for church, putting on his tie, and he sat down on the edge of the bed and said, "Inez, I'm tired." And then he was gone. The funeral's Friday. I came in this morning because I couldn't breathe.

ROBERT
(to Amond, quietly)
Sudden emotional stress. A flood of adrenaline. It stuns the heart muscle. The apex stops moving. It looks exactly like a heart attack, and it isn't one. In Japan they call it takotsubo. Everywhere else, people have been calling it something else for a few thousand years.

AMOND
(beat)
A broken heart.

ROBERT
(nodding)
Your patient has a broken heart, Dr. Baker. Literally. Treat it.

8 INT. PELL PAVILION - 3RD FLOOR - EXAM ROOM 3 - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 7:28 AM

KIARA LATTIMORE (16), in a baggy Sean John hoodie in July, sits on the exam table, arms wrapped around herself. Raven, gloved, finishes an abdominal ultrasound. On the screen there's no appendicitis. There's a fetus, about twenty weeks along. A tiny heartbeat flickers.

Raven turns off the screen before Kiara can see it.

KIARA
Is it my appendix? My cousin had her appendix out.

RAVEN
(carefully)
It's not your appendix. Kiara. Can I ask you a question? Just us. Your mom's in the waiting room. She can't hear.

KIARA
(instantly guarded)
What?

RAVEN
When was your last period?

Kiara stares at the wall. A long time.

KIARA
(barely audible)
March. Maybe February.

RAVEN
Did you know?

Kiara's face crumples.

KIARA
I thought if I didn't think about it, it wouldn't be real. Please don't tell my mother. Please. She'll kill me. She'll send me to my grandmother's in Georgia. Please.

Raven sits down on the stool.

RAVEN
Kiara, in New York, a girl your age can consent to her own prenatal care. That means I can't tell your mother without your permission, and I won't. (beat) But you're about twenty weeks. Halfway. You can't hide in a hoodie for twenty more.

KIARA
(crying)
I know.

RAVEN
So let's figure out how you want to do this. Together. Okay?

9 INT. OLD MAIN - 4TH FLOOR - POST-OP CORRIDOR - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 7:46 AM

Arianna, gloved, pushes a cart loaded with rectal exam supplies, her face set in stone. Kendra Wallace falls into step beside her with a med cart.

KENDRA
(low)
Was that you? The pictures?

ARIANNA
(not looking at her)
I made a few copies.

KENDRA
Why?

ARIANNA
(beat)
Because she walks around this place like she's never been afraid of anything. Like everything just comes to her. Graves picks her. Bullock follows her around like a golden retriever.

KENDRA
(stopping the cart)
You did it because you're jealous?

ARIANNA
I did it because I'm an idiot.

KENDRA
(studying her)
You know what it looks like? You went after a beautiful woman for being beautiful in her underwear. That's the most messed-up thing I've seen you do. Considering.

Arianna flinches. Kendra's not wrong, and they both know exactly what "considering" means.

KENDRA
Fix it.

ARIANNA
How?

KENDRA
I don't know, Gary. That's your job.

10 INT. PELL PAVILION - NEUROSURGERY - DR. GRAVES'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 8:02 AM

Graves at his desk. One of the photocopies lies flat in front of him. Esther stands in the doorway, back straight.

GRAVES
Someone put this under my door.

ESTHER
(evenly)
I'm aware they're circulating, sir.

GRAVES
(looking at her over his glasses)
I'd like you to know two things. One: I've reported it to the Chief, because harassment of a resident on my service is a hospital matter, not a gossip matter. Two... (he folds the copy in half and drops it in his wastebasket) ...it's completely irrelevant to whether you can hold a retractor still.

ESTHER
(beat)
Thank you.

GRAVES
Don't thank me. It's not a favor, it's the standard. (beat) We have a meningioma at nine. You're scrubbing.

11 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDS SURGERY - DR. CRUMP'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 8:41 AM

A cozy, cluttered office: kids' drawings everywhere, a bow-tie rack. Crump at his desk on the speakerphone. Marc stands across from him with Jada's CT films on the lightbox. A large tumor arising from the right kidney, contained.

CRUMP
(into the speaker)
...and the CT shows no obvious spread to the lungs or the liver. The tumor's large but appears contained.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
(on the speaker, warm, measured)
That's encouraging. Dr. Crump, I'll be honest with you. I'm getting a call every fifteen minutes from a very scared father in Decatur who wants his daughter flown to Atlanta tonight.

CRUMP
I appreciate you calling me directly, Dr. Donohue. Truly. But this child is stable, and her mother has custody and wants her here. Queens Grace is a Children's Oncology Group member. We can do this.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
I don't doubt it for a second. The question is what's best for Jada. Who's your surgical team?

CRUMP
Myself. My resident. And an intern who's very good with this family. (glancing up) Dr. Bullock.

A short silence on the line. Marc closes his eyes.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
(a fraction too warm)
Dr. Bullock. Well. (beat) Is it Dr. Marc... Dr. Bullock? Hello, Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(very carefully)
Hello, Dr. Donohue.

CRUMP
(oblivious)
You two know each other?

MARC
(instantly)
By reputation.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
(smooth)
Everyone knows everyone in pediatric surgery, Isaiah. It's a very small family. (beat) Let me talk to the father. I'll call you back within the hour.

The line clicks off. Crump looks at Marc with mild curiosity.

CRUMP
He sounded like he knew you.

MARC
(straight face, terrible)
I have a very memorable voice.

Through the open door, at the nurses' station, Gloria Pettiford is passing with a chart. She heard every word. She keeps walking. Slowly.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

12 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 10:38 AM

Everyone who can sneak away crowds around the TV: Harmony, Raven, two nurses, Big Ray in the doorway. On screen, Space Shuttle Discovery sits on the launch pad at Cape Canaveral, steam rising.

> ON THE TV: CNN LIVE. "RETURN TO FLIGHT: DISCOVERY LAUNCH." The countdown clock reads T-MINUS 00:00:12. The crawl: "...first shuttle launch since Columbia disaster in February 2003..."

CNN ANCHOR (ON TV)
...ten, nine, eight, seven...

Harmony grips Raven's arm. Raven grips back.

CNN ANCHOR (ON TV)
...we have main engine start...
three, two, one... and liftoff.
Liftoff of Space Shuttle
Discovery, returning America to
space...

Discovery rises on a pillar of fire. The room exhales. Somebody claps. Big Ray quietly makes the sign of the cross.

BIG RAY
Two and a half years since
Columbia. Seven people. My nephew
wanted to be an astronaut till
that day.

HARMONY
(watching the shuttle
climb)
They went back up anyway.

RAVEN
That's the whole thing, isn't it.
You go back up anyway.

Marc rushes past the lounge door, chart in hand, mid-sprint, and calls back without stopping:

MARC (O.S.)
Is it up? Did it go up?!

RAVEN
(calling)
It's up!

MARC (O.S.)
(fading down the hall)
YES!

Harmony watches the doorway where he was for a beat too long. Raven watches Harmony watching.

RAVEN
(casually)
You like him.

HARMONY
(instantly)
I like everybody. I'm a Christian.

RAVEN
You like him-like him.

HARMONY
(flushing)
He's our landlord.

RAVEN
He charges four hundred dollars and groceries. He's barely a landlord. He's a man with a house.

HARMONY
(very quietly)
He looks at Esther like she invented the sun. (beat) So it doesn't matter.

Raven looks at her friend. Softens.

RAVEN
It matters to you.

13 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 3 - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 11:05 AM

A meningioma resection. Through the microscope, Graves is peeling a smooth gray tumor away from the surface of the brain. Esther assists, perfectly steady.

GRAVES
A meningioma. Benign, slow, patient. It grows from the covering of the brain, not the brain itself. It's had twelve years to make itself at home. Our job is to evict it without breaking the furniture.

ESTHER
There's a vein draining into it. Right there. On the superior margin.

GRAVES
(checking)
Good eye. If I'd taken that, she'd have had a venous infarct. (beat) Bipolar. You'll coagulate the small feeders on the inferior surface. Gently.

Esther looks up, surprised.

ESTHER
Me?

GRAVES
Do you see anyone else at the table?

Esther takes the bipolar forceps. Breathes. Works, millimeter by millimeter, the tiny vessels sizzling closed.

GRAVES
(watching)
Steady. Steady. Good.

Esther finishes. Hands the bipolar back to the scrub nurse.

GRAVES
(quietly)
Smilley. People are going to look at you your whole career and see whatever they decide to see. A model. A woman. A pretty face. A Black girl from Roxbury. (beat) In here, the only thing that matters is what your hands see.

ESTHER
(behind her mask, moved)
Yes, sir.

14 INT. PELL PAVILION - CT STEP-DOWN - ROOM 5 - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 11:52 AM

Mrs. Boatwright, propped up, still in her usher's dress under a hospital blanket because she refused a gown. Amond adjusts her IV drip.

AMOND
Beta-blocker to slow your heart and protect it from the adrenaline. ACE inhibitor to take some of the work off it. An echo every couple of days. In most people, the heart recovers completely in a few weeks.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
A few weeks. The funeral is Friday.

AMOND
You can't go Friday.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
Young man, I have been married to Lucius Boatwright for forty-one years. I am going to his funeral.

AMOND
Mrs. Boatwright, your left ventricle is pumping at about thirty-five percent. Funerals are emotional. Emotional stress is literally what put you here. If you go to that church and your heart takes another surge of adrenaline...

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
(calmly)
Then I'll see Clarence a little sooner. (beat) Do you have people, Dr. Baker?

Amond stops.

AMOND
My mother. In Los Angeles.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
Your father?

AMOND
(beat)
He died when I was nine. Car accident.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
(gently)
Did you go to his funeral?

AMOND
(after a long moment)
I sat in the front row. I didn't cry. Everyone said I was very brave. (beat) I wasn't brave. I just didn't know how.

Mrs. Boatwright reaches out and takes his hand. The IV line tugs.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
Then you understand why I have to go. I'm not going to sit in a hospital bed in Queens while they put my husband in the ground. I need to say goodbye to him properly, out loud, in front of God and the church.

Amond looks at their hands. Then at the monitor.

AMOND
(quietly)
Let me see what I can do.

15 INT. PELL PAVILION - OB/GYN CLINIC - ULTRASOUND ROOM - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 12:31 PM

Lunch hour. A dim exam room. Elxa lies on the table, scrub top pulled up, looking deeply uncomfortable being a patient. Natasha sits at the ultrasound machine in her white coat. Russell Jeffries stands by Elxa's head in his teacher's cardigan, holding her hand like it's made of glass. The door is locked.

ELXA
This is a conflict of interest.

NATASHA
This isn't a visit. Your OB is Dr. Hampton at Jamaica Hospital, your first appointment is in two weeks, and I'm not touching your chart. (squeezing the gel) I'm a grandmother with an ultrasound machine on my lunch break.

ELXA
(wincing)
Cold.

NATASHA
It's always cold. I've been telling the manufacturer for twenty years.

A soft knock. Natasha frowns. The door opens a crack. Marc slips in and closes it fast behind him.

ELXA
(furious)
Who told you?

MARC
Nobody. I was walking past, and I saw Russell in a cardigan in the OB hallway, and I did some math.

RUSSELL
(to Elxa, apologetic)
I did wear the cardigan.

NATASHA
(not looking up from the screen)
Close the door all the way. And be quiet. Both of you.

She moves the probe across Elxa's belly. Static... shapes... and then, there: a tiny, perfectly formed little bean, and in the middle of it, a fast flickering pulse.

Natasha turns up the volume. The room fills with the sound: whooshwhooshwhooshwhoosh, fast as a hummingbird.

NATASHA
(soft)
One hundred and sixty-eight beats per minute. Ten and a half weeks. Measuring right on time.

Elxa stares at the screen. Russell's eyes fill instantly. Marc puts both hands over his mouth.

ELXA
(whispering)
That's... that's it?

NATASHA
That's your baby, Elxa.

Elxa, the Warden, the most terrifying resident in Queens, starts to cry. Russell kisses her forehead. Marc turns to the wall, shoulders shaking.

ELXA
(crying, to Marc)
Don't you DARE make noise.

MARC
(muffled, crying)
I'm not making noise.

ELXA
You're making noise with your shoulders.

Natasha prints a strip of ultrasound images and hands them to Elxa. She holds them like they're the most valuable thing in the world.

NATASHA
(quietly, almost to herself)
My first grandbaby.

16 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDS SURGERY - DR. CRUMP'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 1:14 PM

Crump on the speakerphone again. Marc, eyes still slightly red, stands by the lightbox.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
...I've spoken with Mr. Spencer three times now. He's frightened, he's guilty that he lives a thousand miles away, and he's convinced that a big name in Atlanta means better care than a hospital in Queens he's never heard of.

CRUMP
Does it?

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
(honestly)
For a contained Wilms tumor in a stable child at a COG institution with a pediatric surgeon of your experience? No. It doesn't. I told him so.

CRUMP
And?

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
And he's booked on a 3 PM Delta flight into LaGuardia. He says nobody's touching his daughter until he gets there. He's talking about lawyers.

Crump sighs heavily and rubs his eyes.

CRUMP
Thank you, Lawrence.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
Isaiah. One more thing. (beat) Is Dr. Bullock still there?

MARC
(wary)
I'm here.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
(gently)
The father's going to come in angry, Dr. Bullock. He's going to be angry at everybody, and most of all at himself. Don't take it personally. He's scared he's losing her in two ways at once.

MARC
(beat)
Yes, sir.

The line clicks. Crump looks at Marc.

CRUMP
Lawrence Donohue doesn't give interns advice on speakerphone.

MARC
(straight face)
He's very generous.

CRUMP
(dry)
Mm-hm.

17 INT. PELL PAVILION - 3RD FLOOR - EXAM ROOM 3 - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 1:50 PM

Kiara sits on the exam table. Raven pulls up the stool. They're rehearsing.

RAVEN
Okay. Say it like you're telling me.

KIARA
(to the wall)
Mama, I'm... I have to... I...

RAVEN
Try looking at me.

KIARA
(looking at Raven, shaking)
Mama. I'm pregnant. Twenty weeks. I'm sorry.

RAVEN
Good. Don't say sorry.

KIARA
Why not? I am sorry.

RAVEN
Because sorry makes it sound like you broke something. You didn't break anything. (beat) Something happened. Now you're going to need help. That's not the same thing.

Kiara pulls her hoodie sleeves down over her hands.

KIARA
The father's nineteen. He's in the Navy. He's in Norfolk. He doesn't even know.

RAVEN
One mama at a time.

KIARA
(beat, small)
Will you be in the room?

RAVEN
Right here. I won't say anything unless you want me to. I'll just be a doctor-shaped wall you can lean on.

18 INT. OLD MAIN - LOBBY - COFFEE CART - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 2:05 PM

The lobby coffee cart. Bernie Watkins stirs three sugars into her coffee. Gloria Pettiford sidles up next to her, ordering nothing, which is how you know she's working.

GLORIA
Bernadette.

BERNIE
(not looking up)
Gloria.

GLORIA
Thirty years we've known each other.

BERNIE
Thirty-one in October.

GLORIA
(casual, deadly)
Who's the tall intern? The one with the dimples. Bullock.

BERNIE
(stirring)
An intern. They've got eighteen. I can't keep track.

GLORIA
You keep track of every parking ticket the Chief's ever gotten. You know the birthday of every board member's wife. And you're telling me you can't keep track of one intern who's six-foot-five?

BERNIE
(finally looking at her, perfectly pleasant)
I type, Gloria.

GLORIA
(beat)
Mm-hm.

BERNIE
(picking up her coffee)
And if I typed anything else, I'd be a lot richer and a lot less employed. (beat) Have a blessed day.

She walks off. Gloria watches her go, then turns to the CART GUY.

GLORIA
Large. Black. I'm going to need it.

19 INT. OLD MAIN - 4TH FLOOR - POST-OP CORRIDOR - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 2:27 PM

Arianna is snapping off her twelfth pair of gloves of the day. Esther comes around the corner. They see each other. Esther keeps walking. Arianna steps into her path.

ARIANNA
Hey.

ESTHER
(not stopping)
I'm busy.

ARIANNA
I made the first copies.

Esther stops. Turns around.

ARIANNA
Twelve copies. At the laundromat. I was going to put one in your locker, to be funny. That's all I meant. Then someone saw them in my bag and asked for one, and someone else made a hundred, and by this morning it was the whole building.

ESTHER
Who's "someone else"?

ARIANNA
(beat)
I don't snitch.

ESTHER
(cold)
But you're fine with being cruel?

That hits. Arianna's jaw tightens.

ARIANNA
I'm not here to make excuses. I'm saying I did it. It was mine. I'm... (struggling) ...it was a garbage thing to do.

ESTHER
Why'd you do it?

Arianna looks at the floor. A long, honest pause.

ARIANNA
Because you look like nothing's ever been hard for you.

Esther laughs, short and incredulous.

ESTHER
(quiet, intense)
When I was twenty-two, I was feeding four people on modeling checks and a scholarship. My mother cleaned offices at night. I posed in that slip because the rent was due and my little sister needed glasses. (beat) You don't know me, Cummings.

ARIANNA
(very quiet)
When I was fourteen, I was feeding three. My dad was on heroin and my mom was off her meds. (beat) I guess I don't.

They stand there, looking at each other. Something shifts between them.

ESTHER
(beat)
That doesn't make it okay.

ARIANNA
I know.

ESTHER
(beat)
Okay.

She walks away. Arianna lets out a breath.

20 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - FRONT ENTRANCE - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 3:41 PM

The doors slide open. DERRICK SPENCER (30), in a wrinkled suit, a carry-on over his shoulder, takes in the room. He's sweating, frantic and furious. He took an earlier flight.

DERRICK
(to the front desk)
Jada Spencer. I'm her father.
Where is she?

Big Ray steps forward.

BIG RAY
Sir, I'll need to see some ID,
and somebody will take you up...

DERRICK
I don't need somebody to take me
up! My baby has CANCER, and her
mother wants some intern in
Queens to cut it out of her!

Heads turn. Marc, crossing the Pit, hears it and stops dead.

Derrick spots the peds wing sign and starts walking fast. Big Ray moves to block him. Tamara comes out of the elevator at the same moment and sees him.

TAMARA
Derrick, don't you dare make a
scene in here...

DERRICK
I'm taking my daughter to Atlanta. Tonight. I've got a lawyer on the phone and a medical flight on standby.

TAMARA
You can't!

DERRICK
Watch me.

Marc steps between them, both hands up, a head taller than both of them.

MARC
(calm, firm)
Mr. Spencer. Mrs. Spencer. Please. Jada is right upstairs, and she can hear people shouting through walls. She's seven. Can we please do this somewhere she can't hear?

Derrick looks up at him. Everyone in the Pit is watching.

DERRICK
(bitter)
And who are you?

MARC
(beat)
I'm the intern.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

21 INT. OLD MAIN - CHIEF OF SURGERY'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 4:05 PM

A tense summit. Natasha behind her desk. FRANKLIN BASSETT (46), hospital General Counsel, with a legal pad. Crump. Derrick and Tamara at opposite ends of the couch, as far apart as the furniture allows. Marc stands by the door.

BASSETT
The divorce decree gives Ms. Spencer primary physical custody and both parents joint legal custody. Either parent can consent to medical care. But when two joint-custody parents actively disagree about a major non-emergency surgery, the hospital's position is that we don't proceed until there's agreement or a court order.

TAMARA
So he gets to just... stop it?

DERRICK
I'm her FATHER!

TAMARA
You're her Christmas-and-two-weeks-in-July father!

NATASHA
(sharp, quiet)
Enough.

Silence. The Chief's voice has that effect.

NATASHA
Mr. Spencer. Mrs. Spencer. Your daughter has a kidney tumor the size of a grapefruit. Every day we spend fighting in this room, it grows. It isn't an emergency today. That can change. (beat) Dr. Crump has operated on more than two hundred Wilms tumors. The Chief of Pediatric Oncology at the Donohue Children's Hospital, the hospital Mr. Spencer wants, has reviewed her films and told you both that she can be treated here safely.

DERRICK
(stubborn)
He said she COULD be treated here. He didn't say she should.

NATASHA
(beat)
Then let's ask him.

She picks up her desk phone and dials a number from memory. Marc's eyes widen very slightly. She puts it on speaker.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
Lawrence Donohue.

NATASHA
(crisp, Chief to colleague)
Dr. Donohue, this is Dr. Natasha Donohue, Chief of Surgery at Queens Grace. I have Mr. and Mrs. Spencer here with me, and Dr. Crump.

A tiny beat on the line.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
(warm, professional)
Natasha. Hello, everyone.

TAMARA
(looking between Natasha and the phone)
Wait. You're both Donohues?

NATASHA
(without missing a beat)
He's my brother. It's a big family.

In the corner, Marc stares at the floor so hard it might crack.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
Mr. Spencer. Derrick. I'm going to tell you exactly what I'd tell my own family. If Jada were my niece, I would want her operated on tomorrow morning, by Dr. Crump, in Queens, with her mother holding her hand in pre-op, and her father right next to her. Then I'd want her oncology care coordinated between New York and Atlanta, so she can see us both, wherever she is. (beat) That's not a compromise. That's the best plan.

Derrick's face cracks. All the fury drains out, leaving only fear.

DERRICK
(quietly)
I just... I wasn't here. When she fell. When they found it. I'm never here.

TAMARA
(beat, gentler)
You're here now.

A long silence.

DERRICK
(to Crump)
Tomorrow morning?

CRUMP
Seven a.m.

DERRICK
(beat)
...Okay.

22 INT. OLD MAIN - 9TH FLOOR CORRIDOR - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 4:31 PM

Everyone files out. Marc hangs back, then falls into step with Crump toward the elevators.

CRUMP
(thoughtful)
Interesting. The Chief's brother, the most famous pediatric oncologist in the South, asks after a first-year intern by name. Twice.

MARC
He's very thorough.

CRUMP
(amused)
"It's a big family." (beat) Dr. Bullock, I've been doing this for thirty-five years, and I've learned not to ask questions whose answers I don't need. (pressing the button) Pre-op labs on Jada tonight. Type and cross. Seven a.m.

MARC
(relieved)
Yes, sir.

Behind them, at Bernie Watkins's desk, Bernie looks up from her typing and watches them go. She smiles to herself. Then goes back to typing.

23 INT. PELL PAVILION - CT STEP-DOWN - ROBERT'S OFFICE - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 5:02 PM

Robert at his desk with vinyl and heart diagrams. Amond stands in front of him with a printed plan.

AMOND
Mrs. Boatwright's husband's funeral is Friday at eleven. Bethel AME in Jamaica. I want her there.

ROBERT
Her ejection fraction is thirty-five percent.

AMOND
It was thirty this morning. The repeat echo at four showed thirty-five. Takotsubo recovers. If she keeps improving, by Thursday she could be at forty-five. We keep her on the beta-blocker. We discharge her Thursday evening with a wearable monitor. Her daughter's a nurse, and she'll be with her. I'll give the daughter my pager number. And EMS can be on standby outside the church.

ROBERT
You want an ambulance outside a funeral.

AMOND
I want her husband buried with his wife there.

Robert leans back. Looks at him.

ROBERT
Two weeks ago you'd have told me she was being irrational. You'd have told me sentiment kills people.

AMOND
(beat)
It does, sometimes.

ROBERT
And?

AMOND
(beat)
And sometimes it's the only reason anybody bothers to stay alive. (beat) She asked me if I went to my father's funeral. I said yes. I didn't tell her I've never been back to his grave. Not once. In seventeen years.

Robert is silent for a long moment.

ROBERT
If her EF is forty or better on Thursday's echo, discharge her with the monitor. And Baker...

AMOND
Sir.

ROBERT
Call your mother this week.

24 INT. PELL PAVILION - 3RD FLOOR - EXAM ROOM 3 - DAY
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 5:24 PM

DENISE LATTIMORE (39), a city bus dispatcher in a crisp MTA uniform, sits in the chair. Kiara is on the exam table, hoodie on. Raven stands against the wall, silent, as promised.

DENISE
They said you had a stomachache. Two hours ago. Why are we still in here? Is it your appendix? Kiara, look at me.

Kiara looks at Raven. Raven gives her a tiny nod.

KIARA
(shaking)
Mama. I'm pregnant. Twenty weeks.

Silence. Denise's face goes through about six emotions in two seconds.

DENISE
(very quiet)
No.

KIARA
Yes.

DENISE
Twenty WEEKS? Five months? Under that hoodie, for five months? In my house?

KIARA
(crying)
I was scared!

DENISE
(standing up)
You were SCARED? I'm your MOTHER! I worked doubles for nine years so you'd never have to be...

She stops. Her face crumples. Her hand goes over her mouth.

DENISE
(whispering)
...so you'd never have to be me.

Kiara looks up, stunned.

KIARA
What?

DENISE
(sitting back down, heavily)
I was seventeen. I hid you under a Starter jacket until Easter. My mother found out at church when my water broke in the pew. (beat) Lord, she slapped me. And then she held my hand for nineteen hours.

Kiara slides off the table. Denise pulls her daughter into her arms, both of them crying.

DENISE
(into Kiara's hair)
I'm not going to slap you, baby.

KIARA
(muffled)
You're going to hold my hand?

DENISE
For however many hours it takes.

Raven slips out quietly and closes the door behind her. In the hallway, she leans against the wall and puts a hand over her heart.

25 INT. OLD MAIN - LOBBY - NIGHT
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 7:12 PM

Evening shift change. The lobby is full: visitors, staff, patients in wheelchairs. Someone has taped one last photocopy of Esther's ad to the glass case of Lockwood's

Lamp itself. A small crowd of staff stand around it, snickering. At the center, a tall, smug male intern from another team: DR. BRYCE KENNERLY (27).

KENNERLY
(loudly)
Confidence is the first layer, y'all.

Arianna, walking through, stops dead. She sees the photo on the lamp. She sees Kennerly. Her face goes cold.

She walks straight to the lamp, rips the photocopy off the glass, crumples it, and turns to Kennerly.

ARIANNA
(loud, carrying across the lobby)
You know what's taped to the glass of this case, Kennerly? The lamp that a woman who was born a slave carried into this building in 1889, because nobody would treat people like her. And you put a picture of a Black woman in her underwear on it to laugh at.

The lobby goes quiet.

KENNERLY
(laughing it off)
Says the girl who made the copies.

ARIANNA
(stepping into his face)
I made twelve. I was wrong. I told her so. You made three hundred on the hospital's copier at two in the morning. I watched you do it. (beat) And I don't snitch, but I'm going to make an exception.

Behind them, Elxa has appeared at the elevator doors, arms crossed. She heard all of it.

ELXA
(icy)
Dr. Kennerly. The Chief's office. Now.

Kennerly's smile disappears. He goes. The crowd scatters. Arianna stands alone by the lamp, her hands shaking. She smooths the crumpled photocopy against her thigh, folds it neatly, and puts it in her pocket.

From the corridor, Esther has seen the whole thing. Arianna sees her seeing. Neither one moves.

26 INT. OLD MAIN - CHIEF OF SURGERY'S OFFICE - NIGHT
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 7:33 PM

Bryce Kennerly stands in front of Natasha's desk. He tries to smile. It doesn't work. Elxa stands by the door, arms folded. Franklin Bassett sits with his legal pad.

KENNERLY
Chief, with respect, it was a joke. It's a public magazine ad. She posed for it. It's not like...

NATASHA
(calm, quiet, and much more frightening than loud)
Dr. Kennerly. Do you know how many women have trained as surgeons in this hospital since 1949?

KENNERLY
(thrown)
No, ma'am.

NATASHA
Four hundred and twelve. I know because I've read every one of their files. And I can tell you that every single one of them, at some point, had some man decide her body was more interesting than her hands. (beat) Some of them quit. Some of them stayed and got stronger. None of them deserved it.

Kennerly's smile is completely gone.

NATASHA
You used hospital equipment at two in the morning to make three hundred copies of a colleague's image to humiliate her, and you taped one to a memorial to our founder. That is not a joke. That is sexual harassment, and it's a violation of this hospital's code of conduct.

BASSETT
(reading)
Two-week suspension without pay, effective immediately. A formal hearing in September. A note in your permanent file.

KENNERLY
(pale)
My file? That follows me for my whole career.

NATASHA
(beat)
Yes. It does. (beat) So does hers. Get out of my office.

Kennerly goes. Elxa watches the door close.

ELXA
(quiet)
Four hundred and twelve?

NATASHA
(taking off her glasses)
Four hundred and thirteen, counting you. I counted you this morning.

27 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDS FLOOR - ROOM 607 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 9:48 PM

Jada, in pajamas covered in cartoon cupcakes, is asleep with her pink cast on top of the blanket. Tamara and Derrick are both in the room, in two chairs on opposite sides of the bed. Marc does a final pre-op check, gently pressing Jada's belly.

Jada stirs. Winces. Opens her eyes.

JADA
(sleepy)
Ow. That hurts.

MARC
(softly)
Where, sweetheart?

JADA
(whimpering)
My whole tummy. It's hot.

Marc's hand stops. He feels again. The belly is firmer than it was an hour ago, distended. He looks at the monitor. Jada's heart rate: 138. Blood pressure: 82/46.

TAMARA
(sitting up)
What? What's happening?

MARC
(already moving, calm, fast)
Her pressure's dropping, and her belly's swelling. I think the tumor's bleeding. (hitting the call button, then grabbing the phone) This is Bullock in 607, I need Dr. Crump and Dr. Elxa Bullock STAT, and get me two units of O-negative and a bolus. NOW.

Derrick is on his feet.

DERRICK
Bleeding? You said it wasn't an emergency!

MARC
It just became one.

Nurses flood in. Jada starts to cry. Tamara grabs her hand. Derrick grabs her other hand. For the first time all day, both parents are holding on to the same thing.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

28 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 6 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 10:21 PM

The pediatric OR with the cartoon animals on the walls. Jada is under anesthesia. Crump is at the table with Elxa first-assisting and Marc on retraction. A unit of blood runs into Jada's IV. Yvette Banks passes instruments.

CRUMP
Transverse upper abdominal incision. Wide exposure. With Wilms tumors, the cardinal rule is no spill. If the capsule ruptures and tumor cells spill into the belly, she needs radiation she might not have needed. We're careful, and we're gentle, and we don't hurry even though everything in your body says hurry.

He opens the abdomen. Blood wells up. Elxa suctions.

ELXA
Retroperitoneal hematoma. The capsule's tense. There's a tear on the inferior pole. Small. It's oozing, but it's contained in the retroperitoneum.

CRUMP
(relieved)
Contained. Thank God. A small bleed into the capsule, not a free rupture. (beat) Dr. Bullock, what does that mean for her?

MARC
It might upstage her, but probably not to stage three if the spill stayed contained. She still has a very good chance.

CRUMP
Correct. Now. Renal vein first.

They work: clamp, ligate, divide. Methodical. Elxa glances at Marc across the table. His retraction is rock steady.

CRUMP
You were right to call it, Dr. Bullock. Fast. Her pressure would have been in the sixties in twenty minutes.

MARC
(quietly)
She said her tummy was hot.

CRUMP
That's how they tell you. They don't say "hypotension." They say "hot."

Crump lifts the tumor, still wrapped in its capsule, kidney and all, out of Jada's body in one piece and lays it in a basin. It's huge. Bigger than her fist.

CRUMP
(softly)
There. Out, intact. (beat) Now we check the lymph nodes and the other kidney, and then we close this baby up.

29 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC SURGICAL WAITING ROOM - NIGHT
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 11:44 PM

A waiting room with a fish tank and a box of donated toys. Tamara sits in one chair. Derrick sits two chairs away. A single vending-machine coffee sits untouched between them.

DERRICK
(staring at the fish tank)
When she was born, I was the one who cut the cord. Did you know my hands were shaking so bad the nurse had to hold the scissors with me?

TAMARA
(beat)
I remember.

DERRICK
I moved to Atlanta for the job. I told myself I'd fly up every month. (beat) I've flown up four times in two years.

TAMARA
(quiet)
I know.

DERRICK
(turning to her)
I'm sorry, Tam. I'm sorry I came in here yelling. I'm sorry I wasn't here when she fell. I'm sorry for...

He can't finish. Tamara looks at him for a long moment. Then she slides the coffee across the chair between them.

TAMARA
Drink this. It's terrible.

He drinks. They sit there. Then, slowly, she moves over one chair. They're side by side now, watching the fish.

30 INT. PELL PAVILION - CT STEP-DOWN - ROOM 5 - NIGHT
TUESDAY, JULY 26, 2005 - 11:58 PM

Mrs. Boatwright is awake, working on a small notepad. She's trying to write, but her hand trembles too much. Amond comes in to check her monitor.

AMOND
You should be asleep.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
I'm writing what I'm going to say Friday. At the church. And look at my hand. I can't write a single word that's straight.

Amond looks at the notepad. Scribbles. He takes off his white coat, hangs it on the chair, sits down and takes the pen.

AMOND
Tell me. I'll write.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
(surprised)
You have patients.

AMOND
You're my patient.

She looks at him for a long moment. Then she closes her eyes and begins.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
"Lucius Boatwright was not a perfect man. He snored like a freight train, and he never once put the cap back on the toothpaste in forty-one years..."

Amond writes, steadily. He bites back a smile.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
"...but every morning of those forty-one years, he brought me coffee in bed before he left for the post office. Even the morning he died. It was still warm when I found him."

Amond's pen stops. He breathes. Writes it down.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
(eyes open, gently)
You okay, Doctor?

AMOND
(not looking up)
Keep going.

31 INT. PELL PAVILION - ELEVATOR - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 12:36 AM

The slow brass elevator. Marc gets in, exhausted and still in his OR cap. The doors are closing when Esther slides in sideways. It's just the two of them.

ESTHER
I heard about Jada. You caught the bleed.

MARC
She said her tummy was hot.

ESTHER
(smiling)
And you listened.

The elevator groans upward. Silence.

ESTHER
(not looking at him)
I heard about the lobby. Arianna. And Kennerly.

MARC
I didn't do anything. I wasn't even there.

ESTHER
I know. That's what's strange. (beat) I wanted you to fix it this morning. Find out who did it and... I don't know. Defend my honor. Something.

MARC
I almost did. I was about to crash out all over the residents' lounge.

ESTHER
(beat)
And instead the person who made the first copies did it. In front of the whole lobby. (shaking her head) I don't even know what to do with that.

MARC
Maybe you don't have to do anything with it.

The elevator stops between floors with a jolt, then keeps going. They both grab the rail. Their hands end up next to each other.

ESTHER
(quiet)
Marc. I have to tell you something, and I need you to just hear it and not ask me any questions.

MARC
(beat)
Okay.

ESTHER
I'm not available. Not right now. It's... complicated. There's something back in Boston that isn't finished. And until it's finished, I can't...

MARC
(gently)
Okay.

ESTHER
That's it? "Okay"?

MARC
You asked me not to ask questions. (beat) I'm not going anywhere, Esther. Whenever it's finished. Or if it never is. I'm still at the table.

DING. The doors open. She looks at him a moment longer, then steps out. Before the doors close, she turns back.

ESTHER
(softly)
Your handwriting is worse than mine.

MARC
(grinning)
I know.

32 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDS STEP-DOWN - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 1:52 AM

Marc is on his cell phone in an empty alcove at the end of the hallway, speaking very low.

MARC
(into the phone)
...she's in recovery. The tumor came out intact. Spill was contained. Crump thinks it'll stay stage two.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
(on the phone, warm, tired, off-duty now)
That's beautiful, Peanut. That's just beautiful.

MARC
(wincing, laughing)
Don't call me Peanut. I'm six-five.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
You were Peanut when you were six. You'll be Peanut when you're sixty. (beat) Your mother nearly gave me a heart attack, calling me on speaker with half the hospital in the room.

MARC
She covered it. "It's a big family."

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
(chuckling)
It IS a big family. (beat, more serious) Marc. Your grandfather is asking why his grandson is working at a hospital that's forty million dollars in the hole and refuses his money. He's asking me, because none of you will answer him.

MARC
Because the answer is Mom.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
I know. (beat) You did good tonight, Peanut. You remember that little girl in Atlanta who beat you at chess?

MARC
(softly)
Every day.

LAWRENCE (V.O.)
She's a pediatrics resident at Emory now. She asked about you last month. I told her you're doing it. Working wherever kids like her are.

Marc closes his eyes, smiling.

Down the hall, around the corner, Gloria Pettiford has stopped walking. She's holding a stack of charts. She heard "Peanut." She heard "your mother." She heard "your grandfather." She turns the corner and quietly walks the other way.

33 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE ROOF - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 2:30 AM

Harmony and Raven sit on the roof, sharing a bag of Doritos, their sneakers up on the parapet. The skyline glitters. Somewhere up there, Discovery is orbiting.

RAVEN
Kiara's mom held her for twenty minutes. And then she called Kiara's grandmother in Georgia and told her, "Mama, you're going to be a great-grandmother, and if you slap anybody, I'm hanging up."

HARMONY
(laughing)
Good for her.

RAVEN
(beat)
So. Marc.

HARMONY
(instantly)
No.

RAVEN
You looked at him at the shuttle launch like he WAS the shuttle.

HARMONY
(putting her face in her hands)
It's terrible. It's so stupid. He's sweet to everyone. He's sweet to the vending machine. He's not sweet to me specifically.

RAVEN
How do you know?

HARMONY
Because I've seen how he's sweet to Esther. (beat) It's a whole different kind of sweet. It's like she's the only patient in the building.

Raven offers her the Doritos. Harmony takes a handful.

RAVEN
My grandma says if your heart's going to break, break it over somebody good. At least then you know your heart's got taste.

HARMONY
(laughing through it)
Your grandma has a saying for everything.

RAVEN
She raised me alone in Yamacraw Village. She had to.

34 INT. OLD MAIN - CHIEF OF SURGERY'S OFFICE - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 2:47 AM

Natasha at her desk, signing the incident report on Dr. Bryce Kennerly. Elxa sits on the couch with her feet up, the ultrasound printout in her hands. She's been staring at it for ten minutes.

NATASHA
Kennerly's suspended for two weeks without pay and has a sexual harassment hearing in September. Cummings gets a written warning in her file for making the original copies.

ELXA
(not looking up)
She stood up in the lobby and owned it. In front of everyone.

NATASHA
That's why it's a warning and not a suspension. (beat) What are you going to do with her?

ELXA
(beat)
Keep her. She's a problem. She's my problem now.

Natasha looks at her daughter over her reading glasses. A small smile.

NATASHA
You sound like me, talking about you.

ELXA
(holding up the ultrasound)
Mom. What if I'm terrible at this?

NATASHA
At what?

ELXA
At being somebody's mother. I'm terrible at being nice. I'm terrible at being soft. My interns are scared of me.

Natasha takes off her glasses. Sets down her pen.

NATASHA
Baby. Your interns are scared of you because you won't let them fail people. Do you know what that is? (beat) That's a mother.

ACT FIVE

35 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ICU - BED 4 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 6:12 AM

Dawn through the window. Jada is in the bed, post-op, drowsy, an epidural catheter in her back, her pink cast propped on a pillow. Tamara is asleep in one chair. Derrick is asleep in the other, his head tipped back, mouth open, snoring. Marc comes in quietly to check her.

JADA
(whispering)
Doctor.

MARC
(whispering back)
Hey, Miss Jada. How's your tummy?

JADA
It's not hot anymore. It's just sore.

MARC
Sore's way better than hot.

Jada looks at her father snoring in the chair.

JADA
(whispering)
Daddy came.

MARC
He flew all the way from Atlanta. He got here so fast he forgot his toothbrush.

JADA
(giggling)
He's loud when he sleeps.

MARC
Very loud.

JADA
(beat, serious)
Did you take the bad thing out?

MARC
Dr. Crump took the bad thing out. All of it, in one piece. Now you're going to get some medicine for a few months so it never comes back.

JADA
Will my hair fall out?

MARC
(honestly)
Maybe a little. With this kind of medicine, sometimes it does and sometimes it doesn't. If it does, it grows back.

JADA
(considering)
My mommy can braid it when it grows back.

MARC
Your mommy's an excellent braider. I can tell.

Derrick snorts and wakes up. Sees Jada awake. He's out of the chair in a second, at her side.

DERRICK
(choking up)
Hey, baby girl. Hey.

JADA
Daddy, you were snoring.

DERRICK
(laughing, crying)
I know, baby. I know.

Tamara wakes up. All three of them are together at the bed. Marc steps quietly back toward the door. Derrick looks over at him.

DERRICK
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Yesterday I asked who you were. You said you were the intern.

MARC
I am the intern.

DERRICK
(shaking his head)
You're the one who heard her say "hot." Thank you.

36 INT. PELL PAVILION - CT STEP-DOWN - ROOM 5 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 7:01 AM

Mrs. Boatwright, sitting up. Her daughter, LYNETTE BOATWRIGHT-REYES (38), a nurse in Mount Sinai scrubs, sits beside her. A portable echo machine is next to the bed. Robert reads the screen. Amond waits.

ROBERT
Ejection fraction... forty-two percent. The apex is starting to move again.

Amond lets out a breath he'd been holding since last night.

ROBERT
(to Mrs. Boatwright)
Your heart's healing, Mrs. Boatwright. Faster than most. If tomorrow's echo looks like this, Dr. Baker is going to send you home Thursday evening with a monitor, your daughter, and his pager number. And on Friday, an ambulance will be parked outside Bethel AME, just in case.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
(to Amond)
You did that?

AMOND
You told me you needed to say goodbye properly. (beat) I wrote down what you wanted to say.

He hands her the notepad. Three pages of his tight, precise handwriting. She reads the first line and starts to cry.

LYNETTE
(reading over her shoulder)
"He never once put the cap back on the toothpaste." (laughing through tears) Mama, you can't say that at his funeral!

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
I can and I will. (to Amond) Would you come? Friday?

Amond looks at Robert. Robert gives the smallest shrug: your call.

AMOND
(beat)
I'm on call Friday.

MRS. BOATWRIGHT
(patting his hand)
Then I'll tell Lucius you said goodbye.

37 INT. OLD MAIN - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 9:14 AM

Post-call. The locker room is clean now. Not one photocopy left. Esther is at her locker, packing up. Arianna comes in, sees her, hesitates and goes to her own locker. They change in silence.

Then Arianna takes something out of her pocket: the crumpled photocopy from the lamp case, smoothed flat now. She holds it out.

ARIANNA
That's the last one. I checked every floor last night. Elevators, bathrooms, stairwells, the chapel. Someone put one in the chapel. (beat) That's the last one in the building.

Esther takes it. Looks at it: herself at twenty-two, in a lace slip, confident in a way she maybe wasn't.

ESTHER
(beat)
I looked good.

ARIANNA
(snorting)
You looked incredible. That was the problem.

Esther almost laughs.

ESTHER
(folding it, putting it in her bag)
Thank you. For the lobby.

ARIANNA
(shrugging, uncomfortable)
Kennerly's a pig. I'd have done it for anybody.

ESTHER
No, you wouldn't.

ARIANNA
(beat)
No. I wouldn't.

They look at each other. A truce. Not a friendship yet. But the ground it'll be built on.

ARIANNA
(shouldering her bag)
See you around, Pantene.

ESTHER
(beat)
Smilley.

ARIANNA
(at the door, beat)
...See you around, Smilley.

38 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - THE BOARD - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 9:31 AM

Elxa stands at the Board updating the census. Marc, post-call, comes in for his bag. On her locker in the background, taped right in the middle, is the ultrasound printout. A tiny bean with a flicker.

MARC
(seeing it)
You put it on your locker.

ELXA
(not turning)
It's my locker.

MARC
Where anyone can see it.

ELXA
I'm tired of hiding things. (beat) I'm telling the program director this afternoon. Officially. Then I'm telling my interns. Then I'm telling anyone who asks. And anybody who has a problem with a pregnant surgical resident can take it up with me directly, in the OR, while I'm holding a scalpel.

MARC
(grinning)
Rule six.

ELXA
(beat, turning)
You realize this means you have to stop hiding things too. Eventually.

MARC
(quiet)
Eventually.

ELXA
(picking up her bag)
Gloria knows something, by the way. She looked at me in the elevator this morning like she was reading a chart.

Marc closes his eyes.

MARC
I know.

TAG

39 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - THE SAILBOAT "CLARENCE" - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 11:46 AM

Bright midday. Planes thunder low into LaGuardia. Esther sits on the deck of the Clarence in a tank top, the photocopy unfolded on her knee. She looks at it a long time. Then she takes a lighter from the galley and holds it to the corner. Thinks better of it. Folds the photocopy and puts it in a book instead.

Her phone buzzes on the deck beside her. The screen: ELEVEN MISSED CALLS. 1 NEW VOICEMAIL. CLAYTON.

She looks at it for a long time. Then she presses PLAY and holds the phone to her ear.

CLAYTON (V.O.)
(on the voicemail, warm, smooth, Boston-educated)
Esther. It's me. Please call me back. I know you're angry. You have every right to be. But you can't keep running from this. We have to talk. We have to settle things. (beat) I'm coming to New York in...

Esther presses DELETE before he can finish. She sets the phone face down on the deck. Breathes.

MARC (V.O.)
Here's the thing about no man's land. You can't stay there forever.

MARC (V.O.)
Sooner or later, everyone has to cross it. Either you go back to who you were, or you keep walking toward who you're going to be.

She looks out at the water, at the planes coming in low over Flushing Bay, one after another.

40 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JULY 27, 2005 - 12:20 PM

Marc, Raven and Harmony at the kitchen table, post-call, eating Raven's perfect grilled cheese for lunch. The radio plays WBLS. Marc is telling a story with huge arm gestures, and Raven is laughing so hard she's crying.

Harmony laughs too. But she's watching Marc. And when he looks over at her and grins, his easy, dimpled, everybody-at-my-table grin, she smiles back... and then looks down at her sandwich.

MARC (V.O.)
The hardest part isn't the walking.

MARC (V.O.)
It's that nobody can cross it for you.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 1x04

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Tuesday, July 26, 2005, 6:44 AM

"I'm not posting the pictures, so don't ask. Whoever papered the locker room with a colleague's old modeling ad: that's not gossip, that's harassment, and it's beneath this building. She stripped to her underwear in front of 30 interns and told them to get it out of their system. Then she went and scrubbed into a brain. LEGEND. Do better, Queens Grace." Comments (48).

nasa.gov: Mission Update, STS-114

Tuesday, July 26, 2005, 10:39 AM EDT

"Space Shuttle Discovery lifted off from Launch Pad 39B at Kennedy Space Center at 10:39 a.m. EDT, beginning NASA's Return to Flight mission, the first shuttle flight since the loss of Columbia and her crew on February 1, 2003."

AIM: GaryGirl400H (Arianna Cummings) and KWallaceRN (Kendra Wallace)

Tuesday, July 26, 2005, 7:58 PM

KWallaceRN: saw the lobby.

GaryGirl400H: everybody saw the lobby.

KWallaceRN: you fixed it.

GaryGirl400H: i broke it first.

KWallaceRN: that's usually how fixing works gary

GaryGirl400H: ...

GaryGirl400H: u working tmrw?

KWallaceRN is away: "night shift. don't call. (unless it's u)"

BlackBerry email: from L. Donohue to N. Donohue

Wednesday, July 27, 2005, 2:09 AM. Subject: Peanut

"Peanut did good. You did good too, Madam Chief. 'It's a big family' will go down in history. Daddy called again asking why Queens Grace won't take his money. I told him to ask you himself. He said, and I quote, 'She'll just say no in that voice.' Love you. Get some sleep. L."

MySpace: profile update, kiki_lattimore88

Wednesday, July 27, 2005, 8:15 AM

Mood: *scared but ok*. Headline changed from "leave me alone" to "one day at a time." New blog entry (private): "told my mom. she didn't slap me. she held my hand. a doctor named raven stood against the wall like a wall. i'm keeping it."

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS: GROUNDED AGAIN

Thursday, July 28, 2005

"NASA grounded the shuttle fleet yesterday, one day after Discovery's triumphant launch, after cameras showed a large chunk of insulating foam breaking off the external tank, the same problem that doomed Columbia in 2003. Discovery's crew is safe in orbit..."

QGH Department of Surgery: internal memorandum

Wednesday, July 27, 2005, 3:30 PM

"TO: General Surgery Residents. FROM: Office of the Program Director. RE: Schedule Adjustments. Effective February 2006, Dr. Elxa Bullock (PGY-2, Track Year 3) will take approved parental leave per departmental policy. Coverage of her service will be arranged by January 1. Please direct questions to the Program Director, not to Dr. Bullock. (Per Dr. Bullock's request: 'especially not to Dr. Bullock.')"

Continuity Sheet: Episode 1x04

New Canon Established

- **The Luxe Noir ad (2002):** Esther, 22, in an ivory lace slip. 'Confidence is the first layer.' She was paid $4,000, which covered Amara's braces and her first-year textbooks.
- **The locker room:** Esther stripped to her underwear in front of about 30 interns: 'This is a body.' The counterpart of Izzie's 1x04 moment.
- **Arianna made the first 12 copies.** Dr. Bryce Kennerly made about 300 on the hospital copier and taped one to Lockwood's Lamp. Arianna exposed him in the lobby. Kennerly: suspended two weeks without pay, with a harassment hearing in September. Arianna: a written warning. Esther and Arianna now have a truce ('See you around, Smilley').
- **Esther to Marc:** 'I'm not available... something back in Boston isn't finished.' Marc: 'I'm still at the table.' Clayton's voicemail ('I'm coming to New York in...') was deleted unfinished, with 11 missed calls.
- **Elxa's first ultrasound** (July 26, 12:31 PM): heart rate 168, 10.5 weeks. Present: Natasha, Russell, Marc. Her OB is Dr. Hampton at Jamaica Hospital. The printout is on her locker. She announced the pregnancy to the program office July 27; parental leave is from February 2006. 'Rule six.'
- **Natasha publicly confirmed Lawrence Donohue is her brother** ('It's a big family'). Marc's connection is still hidden.
- **Gloria overheard** Marc calling Lawrence and heard 'Peanut,' 'your mother,' 'your grandfather.' Her suspicion is now near-certainty. Elxa: 'She looked at me in the elevator like she was reading a chart.'
- **Marc's nickname in the family** is 'Peanut' (from Uncle Lawrence). The chess girl from 1990 is now a pediatrics resident at Emory.
- **Harmony's crush on Marc** is established. Raven knows. 'Break it over somebody good.'
- **Amond:** he has never visited his father's grave in 17 years. Robert told him, 'Call your mother this week.'
- Victor is pressing (through Lawrence) about Queens Grace refusing Foundation money.

Knowledge Tracker

Secret	Knows	Suspects / partial
Marc's identity	Family, Bernie, Graves	Gloria (near-certain), Crump ('I don't ask questions whose answers I don't need')
Elxa's pregnancy	Now public (program office memo, July 27)	-
Arianna and Kendra	Raven	-
Esther's marriage	Esther	Marc ('something in Boston'), Raven and Harmony (the ring)

Secret	Knows	Suspects / partial
Harmony's crush	Raven	-

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Jada Spencer	11/14/1997 (7)	Right Wilms tumor; contained subcapsular bleed	Emergent right radical nephrectomy, intact (Crump; Elxa, Marc)	Stable, likely stage II. Chemo coordinated between New York and Atlanta
Inez Boatwright	4/2/1942 (63)	Takotsubo (stress) cardiomyopathy after her husband's death	Medical management (Robert; Amond)	EF from 30% to 42%. Discharge planned Thursday; funeral Friday
Kiara Lattimore	9/1/1988 (16)	Concealed pregnancy, about 20 weeks	Prenatal care referral; told her mother (Raven)	Continuing the pregnancy
Unnamed female	-	Convexity meningioma	Resection (Graves; Esther used the bipolar)	Uncomplicated

New Characters (to add to MA-005 and MA-006)

- **Dr. Bryce Kennerly**, b. June 11, 1978 (27). Surgical intern (another team). Antagonist. Suspended.
- **Jada Spencer**, **Tamara Spencer** (b. February 20, 1977) and **Derrick Spencer** (b. September 5, 1974, Decatur, GA).
- **Inez Boatwright**, widow of **Lucius Boatwright** (a postal worker, d. July 24, 2005); daughter **Lynette Boatwright-Reyes** (b. 1967), an RN at Mount Sinai.
- **Kiara Lattimore** and her mother **Denise Lattimore** (b. January 7, 1966), an MTA bus dispatcher. **Dr. Hampton**, Elxa's OB at Jamaica Hospital (mentioned).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- July 26, 2005: STS-114 Discovery launched at 10:39 AM EDT, the first flight since Columbia (February 1, 2003). On July 27, NASA grounded future flights over foam shedding.
- Takotsubo cardiomyopathy was well described by 2005, with clean coronary arteries and apical ballooning; recovery over days to weeks is typical. New York minors may consent to their own prenatal care. Joint legal custody and disputes over non-emergency surgery are handled by hospital counsel.
- Wilms tumor: most often found as a painless mass; Children's Oncology Group protocols; 'no spill' radical nephrectomy; a contained subcapsular bleed versus free rupture affects staging. A fetal heart rate of 160-170 at 10 weeks is normal.